

		PERCEPTUAL	FACTUAL	PERCEPTUAL + FACTUAL
ure	Placement Opportunities	Perceptual Ranking	Factual Ranking	Indexed to 100
	1	1	1	100.0
	2	2	7	93.29
	3	3	2	89.57
	4	4	3	74.16
	5	5	8	68.11
	6	6	23	58.48
	7	7	10	51.47
	8	8	5	48.26
	9	9	4	42.25
	10	10	12	38.14
	12	12	9	36.75
	11	11	17	36.74
	13	13	31	35.22
	14	14	30	30.49
	15	15	15	29.88
	16	16	19	27.12
	18	17	26	26.31
	17	18	33	25.96
	19	19	13	25.45
	21	20	16	23.77
	20	21	22	23.12
	22	22	27	22.51
	23	23	6	21.92
	24	24	18	20.05
	25	25	28	16.88
	30	31	14	15.80
	27	27	36	15.56
	26	26	45	15.43
	31	28	24	15.41
	28	30	21	15.41
	28	29	41	14.72
	37	33	38	13.76
	40	39	11	13.62
	34	35	20	13.59
	33	32	39	13.55
	36	34	49	12.51
	32	36	50	12.26
	34	37	48	12.00
	41	41	32	11.93
	38	38	47	11.88
	39	40	40	11.66
	44	44	29	11.32
	42	43	37	11.30
	43	42	44	11.05
	46	45	42	9.87
	47	46	43	9.71
	49	49	25	9.62
	48	48	35	9.58
	44	47	46	9.29
	50	50	34	9.19

and the University of Delhi (DU) offers 1,462 while the University of Calcutta, also in the top five, has 1,996 post-graduate courses.

What is reassuring is that the leading universities are adapting to a constantly changing India and a newer generation entering its classrooms. JNU is about to open a media research centre and offer post-graduate programmes in North-east studies; BIU is developing a 'South Campus' 80 km from Varanasi; the DU has created a placement cell for interaction of students and industry; the University of Calcutta has opened two new research centres in the last two years; the University of Madras is in active research partnerships with foreign universities and industry organisations.

These are impressive achievements but as the demands of the knowledge economy grow, so will the challenges in India's higher education system. These require attention, both to scale as well as detail. Detail means updating syllabi and introducing courses that make the universities contemporary training grounds for the next generation of scholar and scientist alike. Scale involves in dealing with the demands being made on quality educations. India's universities can often be far too sprawling, making it difficult to administer. There is a dispute within the DU, for instance, over introducing a semester system of several examinations in a single year. The DU has 79 colleges, Pune University 269 affiliated colleges and 129 recognised research institutions and the University of Madras has 72 departments of post-graduate learning and 152 affiliated colleges. What certainly needs to be evaluated are these numbers in relation to the structure that makes up a single, efficient, prosperous university.

India's university education is on a razor's edge. Educational reforms need to be pushed through Parliament with not only speed but also clarity and foresight.

As Deepak Pental, vice-chancellor of DU, says, "The need is to bring in more comprehensive universities and not to set up different universities for different educational needs... We need to function the way the rest of the world is operating; otherwise the education system will suffer impediments." India's knowledge economy can produce the best; naturally, it demands the same. ■